



*Plates, bowls,
and food were
turned to gold.*

smiled widely as it turned to shining gold.

Midas wandered around his palace, touching the pillars and watching the stone transform beneath his fingers. His servants clapped their hands in delight as he turned one thing after another into the precious yellow metal. Midas ordered a great feast in celebration.

*Platters of fruit and jugs of wine
were brought by the cartload to the
now-golden table.*

As soon as Midas tried to eat some of the delicious food, however, he realized his terrible mistake. When he raised the first slice of bread to his mouth, it grew heavy and turned to gold. The same thing happened to the wine in his goblet as it reached his lips. Midas was distraught. "Dionysus, please take back your gift," he cried.

The god appeared and took pity on the king. "Climb the Lydian Hills and wash your hands in the river there," Dionysus told him. "Then you will be free." Midas set off immediately.

At the Lydian River, Midas plunged his hands into the water and the power was washed away. For many years that followed, the gold from Midas's hands could be found on the riverbed.